# ADELINE BEAN

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The National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine
Gulf Research Program, Future of Gulf Energy Systems
Washington, D.C.

Dear Selection Committee,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Associate Program Officer position in the Gulf Research Program's Future of Gulf Energy Systems unit. The question of what to do with aging offshore oil and gas infrastructure, and how the Gulf's energy systems should evolve, affects workers, communities, and ecosystems all at once, and I am drawn to the Program's approach of bringing government, industry, nonprofits, and researchers together around evidence. Helping to build and sustain a community of practice on these issues is work I would find deeply meaningful.

My policy work has given me a strong foundation in energy issues. At Holland & Knight, I follow federal energy, infrastructure, and environmental developments in Congress and federal agencies and write background research and briefings for attorneys and former Members of Congress. I have learned to get up to speed quickly on technical subjects by starting with primary sources and then writing for a reader who is not a specialist. Coordinating edits from several reviewers on published client alerts has also taught me to manage a document through to final form while keeping everyone informed and on schedule.

I am especially excited by the relationship side of this role. In Representative DeGette's office, I worked with constituents and federal agencies and learned that trust comes from responsiveness and careful follow-through. As co-founder and executive editor of Georgetown's Undergraduate Law Journal, I coordinate a team of volunteer contributors, set timelines, and keep track of every submission and deliverable, which is much like supporting a group of grantees and partners. I enjoy building systems for records and tracking so that information is easy to find and reports are easy to produce. I use AI tools to work efficiently while verifying every fact.

I would be excited to support the Program Officers in managing grantee relationships, solicitations, and convenings, and to help the Future of Gulf Energy Systems portfolio reach the people who can use its insights. Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how I could contribute to your team.

Sincerely,
Adeline Bean